Tree Rings on One Timeline

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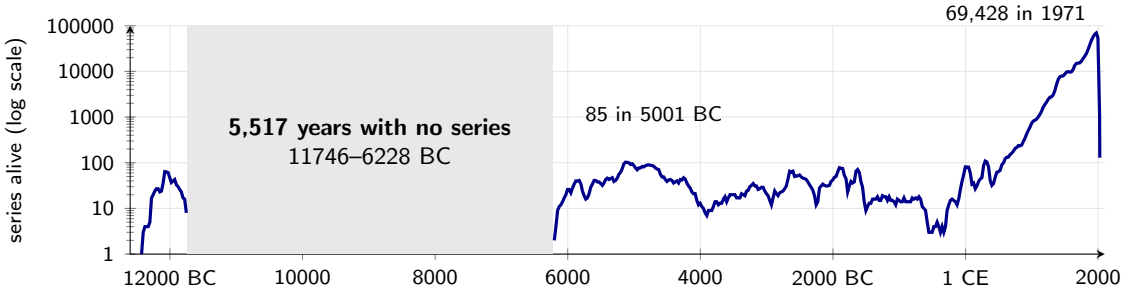
Hackers Conference, November 2026

The record is huge, and almost all of it is recent

123,910
measured tree-ring series

16.0 million
tree-years

14,454 years
12429 BC to 2025 CE



The hole is in public access, not in the wood: published chronologies run through it.

The data is scattered, and the oldest is the hardest to get

Source	What it holds	Access	On the site
ITRDB (NOAA)	285,774 series; 85,186 in our region	Open	Curves
PANGAEA	Hohenheim archive: 38,184 timbers	Dates public, widths closed	Bars only
Zenodo	540 Neolithic oaks, from one paper	Open, CC BY	Curves
DCCD	30,135 files; old server gone	Guestbook, No Derivatives	Asking
IntCal archive	39 new European trees	Terms unclear	Not yet
CEZA Mannheim	About 3,000 boxes, being digitized	Not public	Not yet

- **No common index:** one registry of repositories didn't even list DCCD.
- **No common format:** fixed-width Tucson, Heidelberg, TRiDaS XML.
- **Open is not simple:** licences may let you read data but not redraw it. "No Derivatives" lets you add data to a larger collection unchanged, but not correct it, and may bar merging it into a database.

Checking everything found real errors, including ours

Ours

- **111 Ice Age pines drawn at 1–434 CE**, off by over 10,000 years. No error raised: we were reading a silently frozen metadata format.
- **Every BC label one year late.** The files have a year 0.
- **"Nothing on PANGAEA."** We searched by name; 53,094 records were there.

The archives'

- **152 files disagreed with their own records**, 19 by over 100 years. We reported them; NOAA worked through them: 12 left.
- **3,424 series withdrawn but still served**; we withhold them.
- **Ring widths alone caught one-year slips** in pines from about 6200 BC, confirming a depositor's note and flagging a new candidate.

Sources fail silently, so we cross-check: spans match dplR, an independent reader, on all 76,397 series it reads.
Next: recompute the alignments from the rings, so overlaps are verified, not just asserted.